

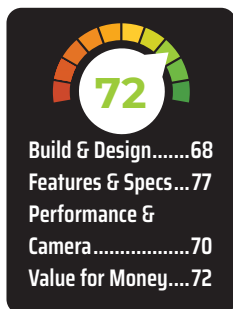
Realme P1 5G

Unrivalled performance in its price segment

With the Redmi Note and Realme 'number' lineup's recent uptick in price, the ₹15-20K smartphone segment is ripe for some healthy competition. These phones were once the defacto choice in the sub-₹20,000 price segment, however, given these phones are now a more premium proposition, we need fresh new alternatives in this segment. Enter the Realme 'P' series of phones featuring the Realme P1 and Realme P1 Pro. Realme has positioned the P series as its performance-focused lineup of smartphones. I got the former for review and was immediately intrigued by it. I was excited to see what a performance-focused budget offering would be like from Realme because the company has historically gone for dominance in the design and camera areas. With the P1, Realme hasn't completely abandoned its design and camera focus, but they have made some sacrifices to ensure pro-level performance. The phone houses the MediaTek Dimensity 7050 chipset backed with up to 8 GB RAM and up to 256 GB UFS 3.1 storage. I put the phone and its chipset to the test to see if it is the fastest phone under ₹16,000. Here's what I found.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Realme has carefully curated a design language that has been standardised across its portfolio now. The Realme P1 follows that to the tee. The phone is available in two striking colourways – Phoenix Red and Peacock Green. The plastic rear panel has a matte texture with a feather-like pattern. Realme has dubbed this the "Bird Culture Inspired Design". I think it is tastefully



designed, but some may find it a tad gaudy. The large circular module makes a reappearance, complete with the CD-like pattern. It houses what looks like four cameras but two of these are dummy camera lookalikes. The frame is colour-matched – a detail we appreciate. The buttons are nice and tactile, and the in-display fingerprint display is sufficiently accurate and fast. The phone weighs 188 g and is 7.97 mm thick, but the flat, sharp sides dig into the palm making it uncomfortable to hold for long periods.

The phone supports 5G dual carrier aggregation, IP54 dust and water resistance, and Hi-Res dual stereo speakers. The speakers are some of the loudest I've heard at this price with weighty lows and clear highs. The phone has Rainwater Smart Touch, meaning the display can function even when wet. It worked perfectly during our testing period. One gripe is the lack of Gorilla Glass protection, which is disappointing

given that some competitors offer Gorilla Glass even at this price.

DISPLAY

Realme has not compromised on the display of the Realme P1 despite its primary priority being performance. You get a solid 6.67-inch AMOLED screen with FHD+ resolution and support for 120 Hz refresh rate. In contrast, the Motorola G54 features a dated IPS LCD display. This is also one bright display with a rated peak brightness of a whopping 2,000 nits. The bezels are quite thick though, especially the top and chin bezels.

For content consumption and day-to-day usage, the Realme P1's display doesn't give you a lot to complain about. It is ridiculously bright; I got a reading of 1,312 nits in my test under direct sunlight, which means legibility in on bright, sunny days is not an issue. Moreover, the colours look fairly accurate and the viewing angles are excellent. The display supports HDR but it only works in YouTube; the HDR support for other OTT apps is missing.

PERFORMANCE

Realme has made some big claims with the P1. The company claims that the Realme P1 has the fastest chipset in the segment. In comparison to similarly-priced competition, this does seem to be true. The Realme P1 houses the MediaTek Dimensity 7050 SoC which has two Cortex-A78 cores clocked at 2.6 GHz and six Cortex-A55 efficiency cores clocked at 2.0 GHz. You also get up to 8 GB LPDDR4X RAM and up to 256 GB of UFS 3.1 storage. Having UFS 3.1 sets the Realme P1 apart since many phones nearing the ₹20K price point still feature UFS 2.2 storage speeds. It shows up with the highest sequential read and write speeds under ₹16K.

The Realme P1 left its competition in the dust in nearly all of our benchmarking tests as well. It scored a whopping 6,07,055 points in AnTuTu v10 beating out the POCO X6 Neo and Motorola G54. This result repeats itself in Geekbench's Single Core and